

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Help! I have no Internet!



Learning Outcome

Explain about technology and technical problems in communicative situations.

Ask your partner:

- Do you know what to do if there is a problem with your Internet connection?
- Who do you call? What questions would you ask?

Can Do Statements

- I can write about technology.
- I can ask for help or advice in a written way.
- I can write about how to deal with problems.





Let's Explore!

Vanessa contacts her Internet provider. A **customer service agent*** named Rachel is there to assist her.

* A "customer service agent" is a person employed to assist customer with their questions and queries



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Rachel:** Hello, this is Rachel from InternetPlus. How may I help you?
- Vanessa:** I need to speak with someone about my Internet connection.
- Rachel:** Absolutely! What seems to be the problem?
- Vanessa:** Do you know how to connect a new modem?
- I just purchased a new one and I can't seem to get the Internet to work.
- Rachel:** Before you start, you should read the manual.
- Vanessa:** Hmm ... I forgot, sorry.
- Rachel:** No problem. I would start by connecting all the cords and turning on the modem first, followed by the computer.
- Vanessa:** Hmm ... alright. Could you tell me where to plug in the Ethernet cable? All these cables look the same to me.
- Rachel:** The ethernet cable goes in a large socket on the side of your computer. It should be blue.
- Vanessa:** Found it! OK, done. Let me see what happens. Oh goodness ... Can you explain what to do now that the green light on the modem is flashing?
- Rachel:** Don't worry ... that means that it's trying to connect to the Internet provider. Give it a minute. Also, I wouldn't try to connect to the Wi-Fi until you are confident that the modem is working properly.
- Vanessa:** I understand. The green light has stopped flashing. I'm going to log in and see if I can go online. Yeah! I'm in!
- Rachel:** Is there anything else I can help you with? You could receive monthly e-mails about online tips and tricks, if you are interested.
- Vanessa:** No, thank you. You've been very helpful.





Let's Practice!

Rachel, from customer support is working in a call center*. She has a number of ideas to deal with Vanessa's Internet problems.

*This is a large office that answers customers questions and provides information on products.

Instructions: Proofread the sentences below and circle the mistakes.

1. Also, I wulden't try to connect to the wisi until you are confident that the modem is working properly.
2. I wood start by connecting all the chords and turning on the modim first, followed by the computer.
3. You does receive a monthly e-mail about online types and tricks, if you are interested.
4. You shoood read the manuel that came with the modem.



Let's Practice!

Can you write about technology? Could you ask questions to a customer service representative like Vanessa?

Instructions: Imagine you have just bought a new piece of technological equipment, but it is not working properly. You have to call a customer service representative. Write a 10-12 line dialogue between you and a customer service representative.

My Dialogue





Extension Activity

How can I help you?

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Complete a 2 - 3 minute role play about dealing with a problem with technology.
- You and your partner will pretend you are a customer and customer service representative.
- Decide on two pieces of technology that are not working properly.
- Talk about these items one at a time.
- Write down the questions you are going to ask your partner about the item.
- Explain the problem to your partner as the customer. Ask questions using *how to*, *where to*, *when to* and *what to*.
- The customer service representative should provide suggestions on how to deal with the problem, like *I would read the manual to learn more about the product*.
- Then, switch roles.

Self-Assessment

Yes No

I complete a role play about technology with a partner.

☐ ☐

I write down questions about a piece of technology.

☐ ☐

I ask questions using *how to*, *where to* and *what to*.

☐ ☐

I provide suggestions to deal with problems.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- connection** (noun): something that links one source to another, such as a computer or telephone
e.g. I need to speak with someone about my Internet connection.
- cord** (noun): a wire along which electricity passes from a power source to a device
e.g. I would start by connecting all the cords and turning on the modem first, followed by the computer.
- Ethernet cable** (noun): a system of wires and devices for connecting computers so that they can work together
e.g. Could you describe to me where to plug in the Ethernet cable?
- modem** (noun): a device that facilitates the exchange of information between computers
e.g. Do you know how to connect a new modem?
- Internet provider** (noun): a group or company that provides Internet service
e.g. That means that it's trying to connect to the Internet provider.
- Wi-Fi** (noun): wireless Internet
e.g. I wouldn't try to connect the Wi-Fi until you are confident that the modem is working properly.
- to connect** (verb): to join together
e.g. I would start by connecting all the cords and turning on the modem first, followed by the computer.
- manual** (noun): a small book that gives useful information about something
e.g. You should read the manual that comes with the modem before you start.





Learning Points

Asking for Help and Advice

There are several ways to ask for help in English. You can use polite and casual language to do this. Let's look at one particular structure for asking for help.

You can use the structure

Can/ Could + you + show/ tell + me + question word

Can/Could	you	show/tell	me	Question word
<i>Could</i>	<i>you</i>	<i>tell</i>	<i>me</i>	what to do with these cables?
<i>Can</i>	<i>you</i>	<i>tell</i>	<i>me</i>	how to connect to the Internet?
<i>Could</i>	<i>you</i>	<i>show</i>	<i>me</i>	where to find the port for the Ethernet cable?
<i>Can</i>	<i>you</i>	<i>tell</i>	<i>me</i>	when to press the flashing green light?

You can also use the structure

Let me show/ tell + you + question word

Let me show you how to stand.

Let me show you where it is.

Let me tell you what you should do.





Learning Points

Discussing How to Deal with Problems

To discuss how to deal with problems such as computer connection problems, you can use modals like *might*, *could*, or *should*.

These modals can go at the beginning of the sentence, or after a clause starting with "*If ...* "

The modal is followed by a verb in the base form. You do not use "to".

I would/I'd ...
I wouldn't ...
You could ...

Examples:

- *You could receive monthly e-mails about online tips and tricks, if you are interested.*
- *Also, I wouldn't try to connect to the Wi-Fi until you are confident that the modem is working properly.*
- *I would start by connecting all the cords and turning on the modem first, followed by the computer.*

